Olivia Kalicinski

Artist Statment

I reflect on how we live today: busy, interconnected, and overwhelmed by endless stimuli. We consume objects, images, and information at an unrelenting pace, leaving behind traces that accumulate without much thought. Life moves quickly, and in the rush, we often lose sight of ourselves, each other, and the natural world around us.

Through clay shaped and fired in fire pits, combined with electronic waste, organic matter, and other discarded materials, I create sculptures, engravings, and installations that embody the tension between past, present, and future. My photographs also construct this narrative, reflecting on the cycle of life-death-life and capturing the subtle dialogues between human interventions and nature's responses.

Through my creative process, I offer a space for pause, estrangement, curiosity, and reflection. What are we doing to the world? And what is the world doing to us? I aim to inspire a critical perspective, encouraging a reconnection with the earth, with time, and with our essence.

Photography Portfolio



Gate is straight, deep and wide
2024



Break on through to the other side
2024



Adagio

2024



Locked In, Locked Out
2024



Safe Nest

2024

During an artist residency in Serra da Mantiqueira I met Kalmô, a Brazilian artist whose story deeply moved me. She explores ancestry and the inherited traumas passed through generations. Marked by the absence of a nest, we found her own. In an abandoned space, an intact nest revealed itself amidst a destroyed room. I used it as a symbol in a portrait of Kalmô. Through the broken window, I captured her strength and vulnerability, reflecting her struggles and her beauty.



Theo Giachetti

2024

During an artist residency in Serra da Mantiqueira, in October, I met Theo, a French artist with an incredible ability to "hunt" the miniature world with an intuitive and sharp eye. His balanced relationship with nature caught my attention. On the way to the location, Theo "hunted" the cicadas that became part of the portrait. I created his photo in an abandoned space, with a blue, fungi-covered wall and soft afternoon light, blending his authenticity with a surreal intimacy.



Serie, Data Dump
2024





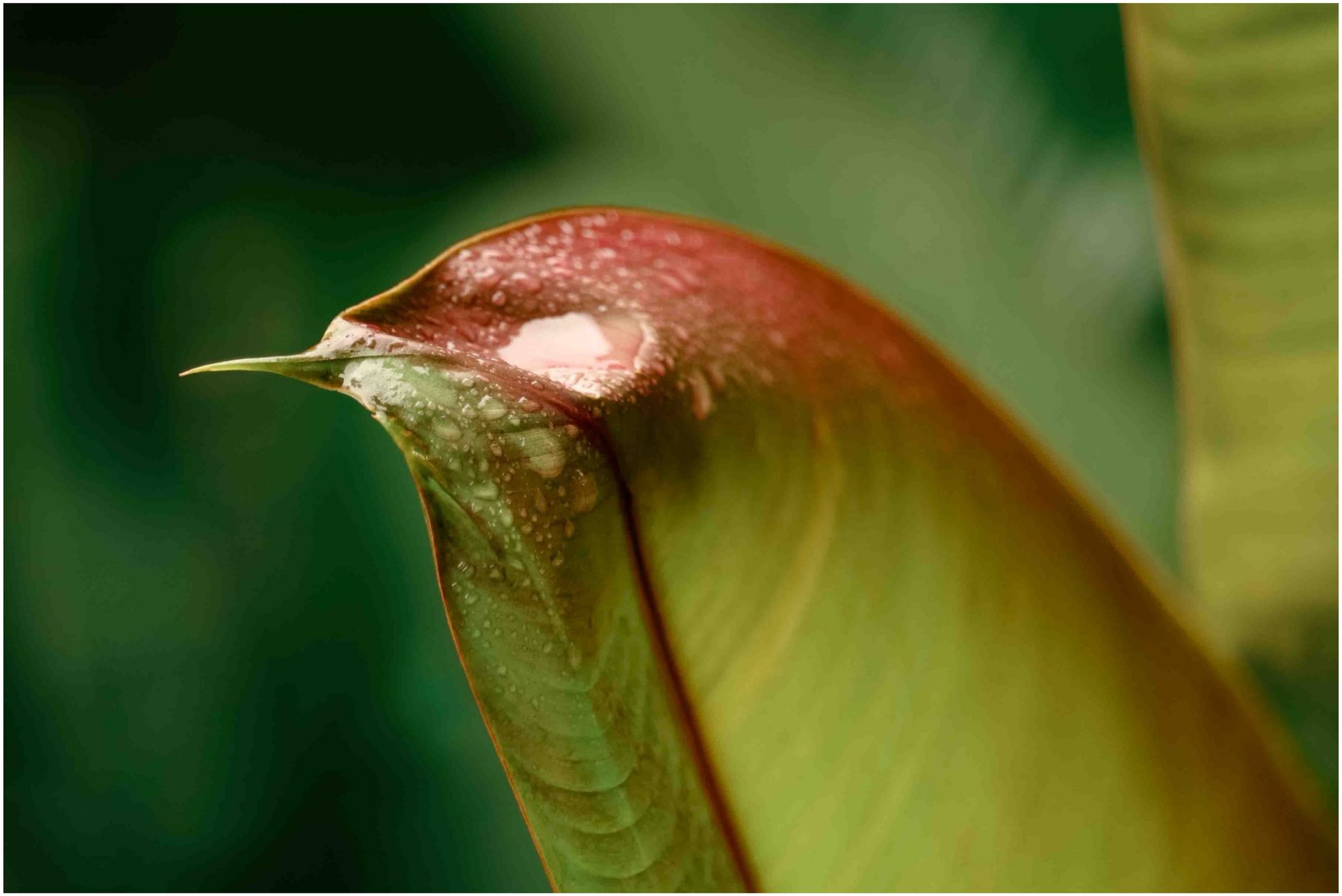




Data Dump
2024



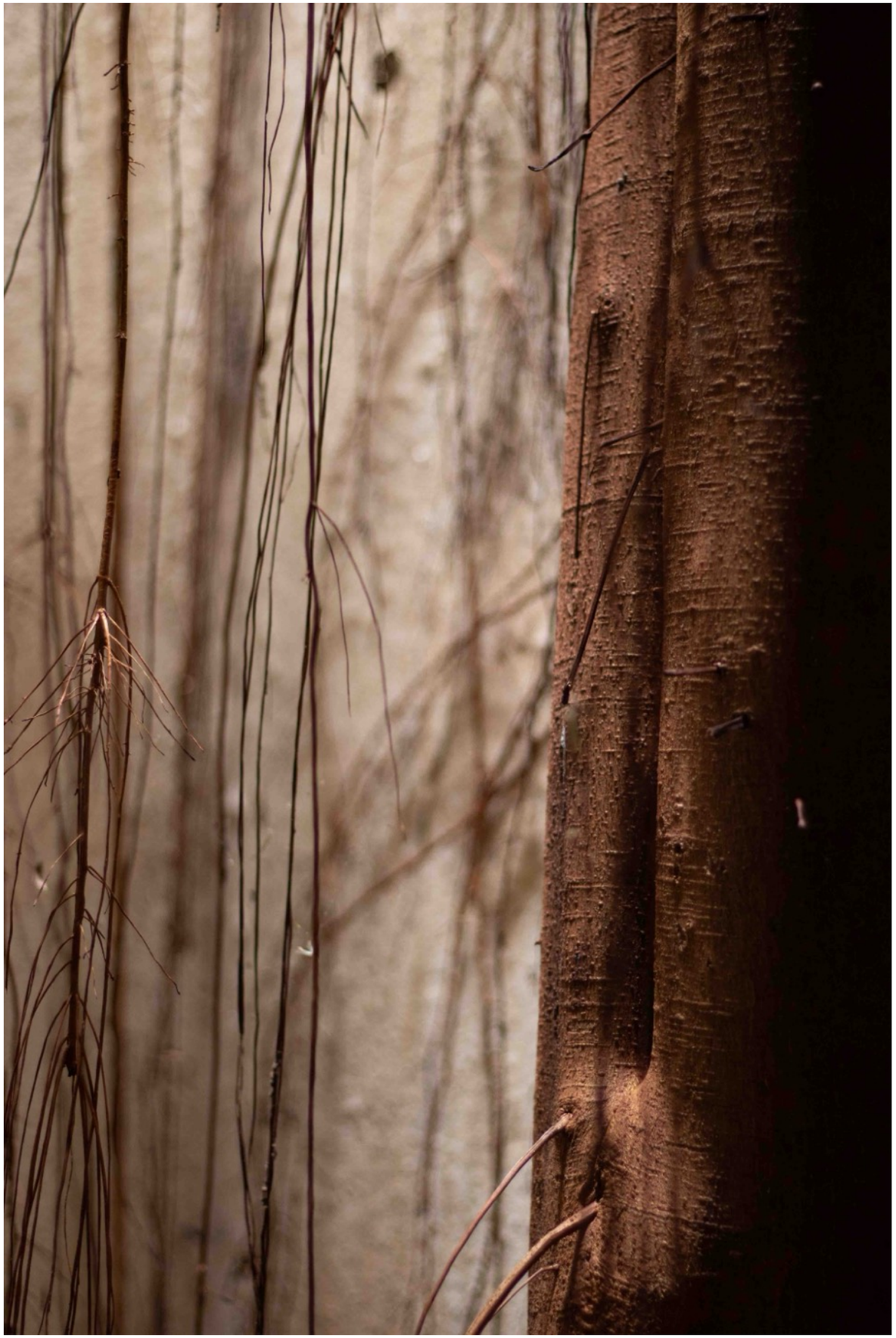
Untitled
2024



Araponga
2024



Embaúba
2024



Embaúba

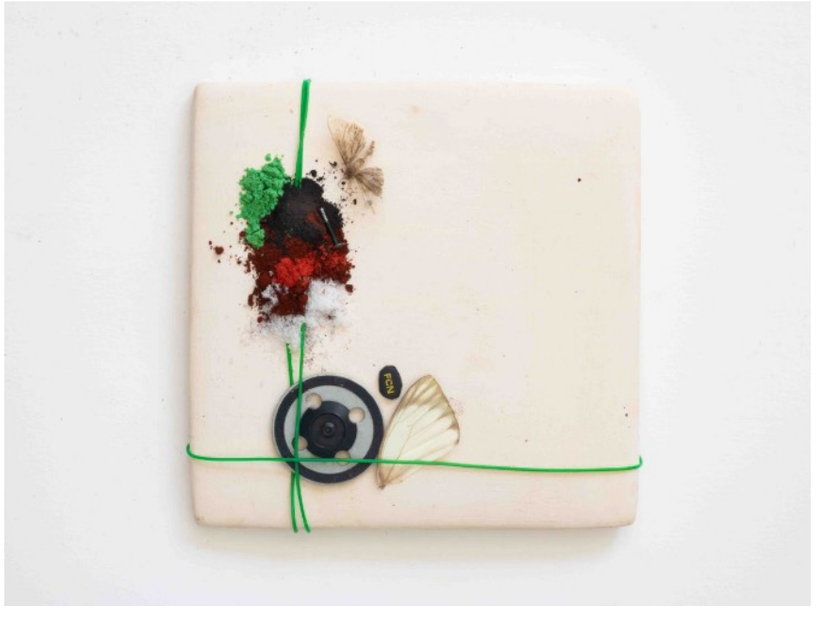
2024

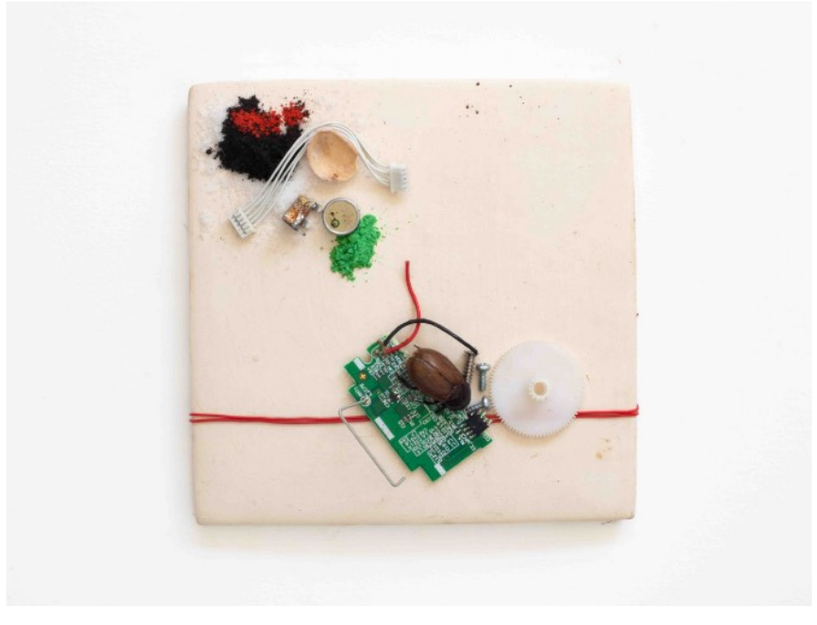
In October 2024 I captured this abandoned space where the embaúba, a symbol of resilience, emerges. Its roots descend along the wall, reclaiming the the space and turning it into renewal. The embaúba, a pioneer in regenerating degraded areas at the Rain Forest, reflects the life-death-life cycle and the transformative power of nature.

Art Portfolio







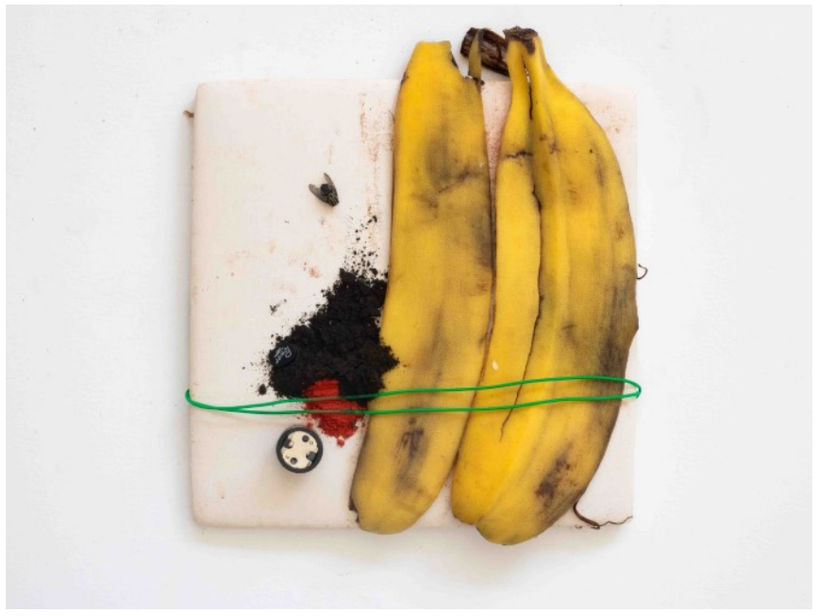


Bug

2024

Installation composed of raw ceramic tiles, assembled like a painting, featuring elements such as dead insects, remote control buttons, colored powders, cable plugs, computer chips, and other technological waste.

15 x 15 x 2 cm (each tile)









Untitled

2024

IInstallation composed of raw ceramic tiles, assembled like a painting, featuring banana peels in various stages of decomposition, wires, technological waste, colored powders, fragments of obsolete objects, and dead animals and other natural elements.

15 x 15 x 2 cm (each tile)



Cabaças
2024
Wheel-thrown ceramic objects, engraving with waste, fire pit firing
Various sizes



Untitled
2024
Ceramic tile, engraving with waste, fire pit firing 25 x 15 x 1 cm



Untitled
2024
3D Ceramic objects featuring banana peels, wires, sheep whool and colored powders.
30 x 25 x 15cm

Professional Summary

Olivia Kalicinski is a Brazilian visual artist whose practice spans photography, sculpture, printmaking, and installation. Her projects explore themes such as time, transformation, and sustainability, often adopting a critical approach to the impact of modernity on nature and memory. Combining natural and technological materials, she creates works that bridge the natural and artificial, the ephemeral and the permanent. Olivia has a strong connection to Germany, having lived in Hamburg and maintaining close ties with family and friends in the country. She is of Austrian and German descent, speaks German at an intermediate level, and is fluent in English.

Exhibitions / Awards

- Festival do Minuto (2024) – Awarded in the “Nano Minute” category for the video "Incêndio."
- Casa da Escada Colorida Group Exhibition (2023)
- EAV Group Exhibition, School of Visual Arts at Parque Lage (2021)

Residencies, Mentorships, and Artistic Training

- Selected with scholarship to Photography Critical Mentorship with André Penteado (2024 – Present)
- Casero Art Residency, Itatiaia National Park, Serra da Mantiqueira (October 2024)
- Critical Mentorship with Bruno Miguel, School of Visual Arts at Parque Lage (2022 – Present)
- Selected with scholarship to the Critical Mentorship with Ana Elisa Lizidia, Casa da Escada Colorida (2023)
- Languages of Space and Time: Return to the Physical World - Course with Fabiana Éboli, School of Visual Arts at Parque Lage (2021)
- Mentorship and Ceramics Classes with Vera Machado, Rio de Janeiro (2018 - 2020)